

NPTEL ONLINE CERTIFICATION COURSES

Employment Communication **- A Lab based course**

Dr Seema Singh
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Topic

Lecture 11: Body Language - Introduction

CONCEPTS COVERED

Kinesics – I

- a. Oculistics / Eye Behavior
- b. Facial Expressions
- c. Posture
- d. Gesture



Kinesics

(contd.)

CONCEPTS COVERED

1. Eye Communication
2. Facial Expressions
3. Posture and Movement
4. Gestures
5. Dress and Appearance
6. Voice and Delivery
7. Non-words



Kinesics

- The study of human body motion, popularly referred to as “Body Language”
- Any movement of the face or body that communicates a message
- Consists of :
 - (a) Oculesics / Eye Behavior
 - (b) Facial Expressions
 - (c) Posture
 - (d) Gesture

Decoding Body Language ?



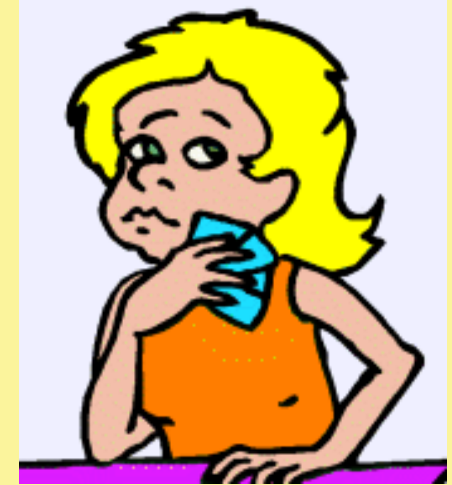
KINESICS: (a) Eye Behavior or Oculesics

- Study of eye movement or eye behavior
- A category of Kinesics and a sub - category of Facial Expressions that includes any movement or behavior of the Eye
- Also called Gaze / Eye Contact

The Eyes Have It !

Centered	Focused
Gazing Up	Thinking
Gazing Down	Shame
Gaze on the side	Guilty
Wandering	Disinterested, Bored

Guess Me ?



A. KINESICS: (b) Facial Expressions



Configuration of the face that can reflect, augment, contradict, or be unrelated to a speaker's vocal delivery

Did you know that ... ?

- the 80 muscles in the face can create more than expressions ?
- the is the single most important broadcaster of emotions ?

A. KINESICS: (b) Facial Expression

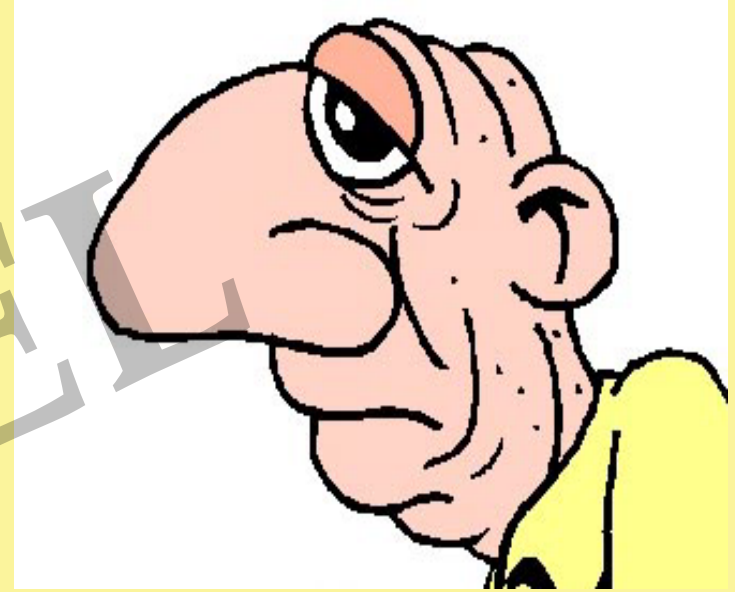
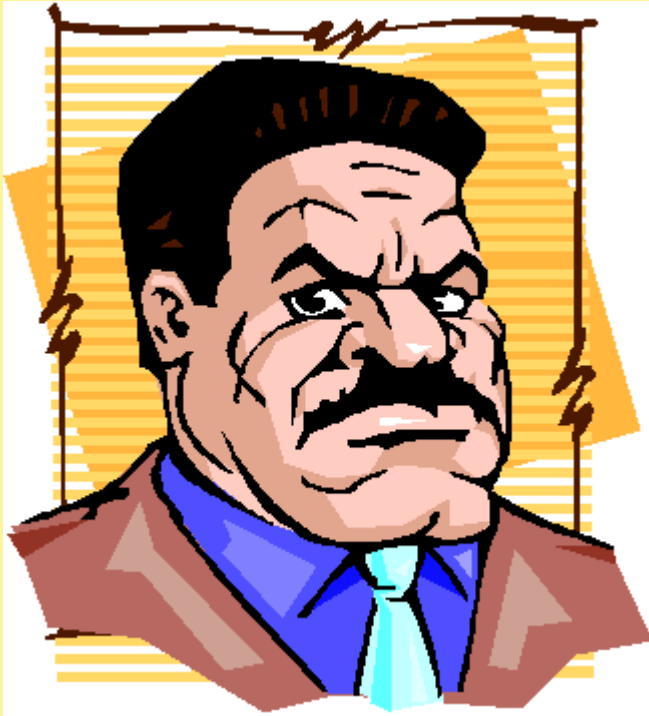


Facial Management Techniques: Control of facial muscles to conceal inappropriate or unacceptable responses

Facial Expression/s

Forehead	Wrinkles	Anger
Eyebrows	Outer edges up	Anger
Nose	Upward	Contempt

Read me !!



A. KINESICS: (c) Posture

- The way a person stands, leans forward or back, and moves the head
- The bearing with which one proclaims one's position in life
 - Nancy Henley, Body Politics

Two basic groups of Body Language postures

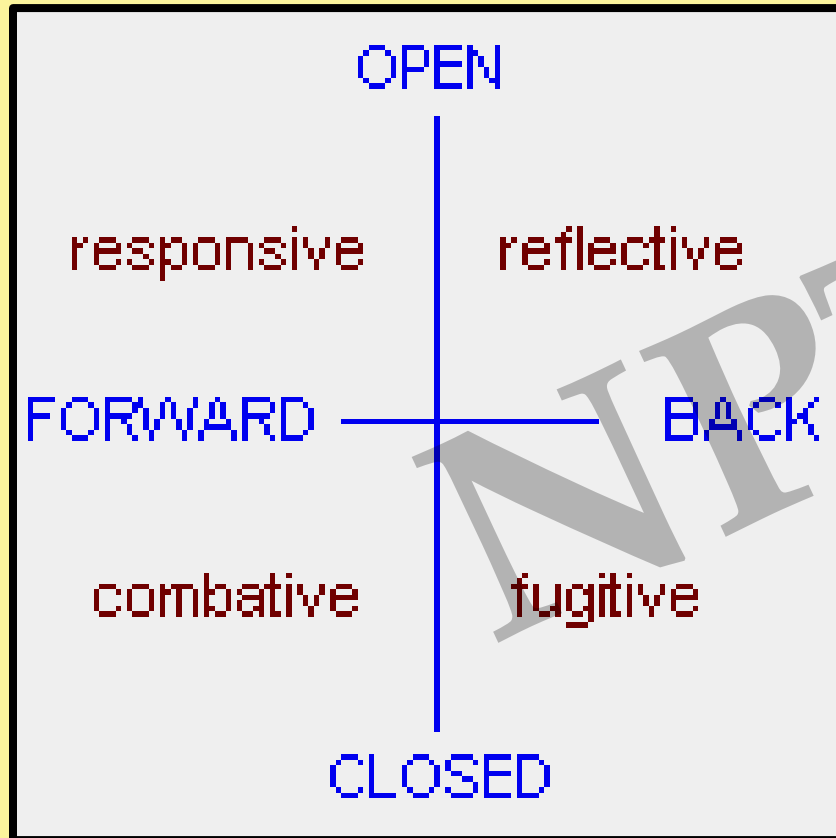
OPEN / CLOSED

People with arms folded and legs crossed and bodies turned away are signaling that they are rejecting messages. People showing open hands, fully facing you and both feet planted on the ground are accepting them.

FORWARD / BACK

When people are leaning forward and pointing towards you they are actively accepting or rejecting the message. When they are leaning back, looking up at the ceiling, doodling on a pad, cleaning their glasses they are either passively absorbing or ignoring it.

Body Language at the Workplace



Mind your Manners,

John Mole

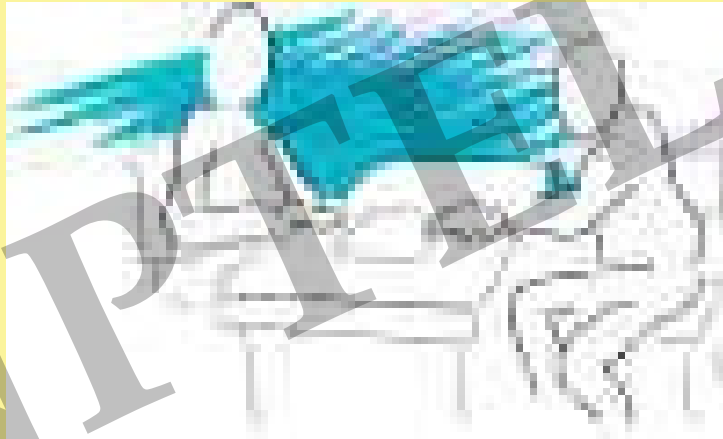
Responsive (1 of 3)

- **ENGAGED** leaning forward
- Open body
- Open arms
- Open hands



Responsive (2 of 3)

- EAGER (sprint position)
- Open legs
- Feet under chair
- On toes
- Leaning forward



Responsive (3 of 3)

- **READY TO AGREE** (closes papers)
- **Pen down**
- **Hands flat on table**



Reflective (1 of 3)

- LISTENING head tilted
- Lots of eye contact
- Nodding
- High blink rate



Reflective (2 of 3)

- EVALUATING sucking glasses/pencil
- Stroking chin
- Looking up and right
- Legs crossed in 4 pos.
- (ankle on knee)



Reflective (3 of 3)

- ATTENTIVE (standing)
- arms behind back
- smile
- open feet



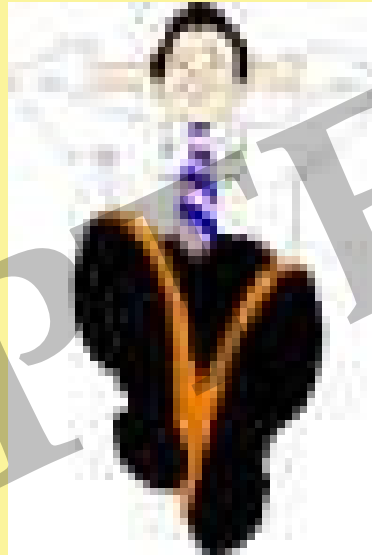
Fugitive (1 of 3)

- BORED staring into space
- Slumped posture
- Doodling
- Foot tapping



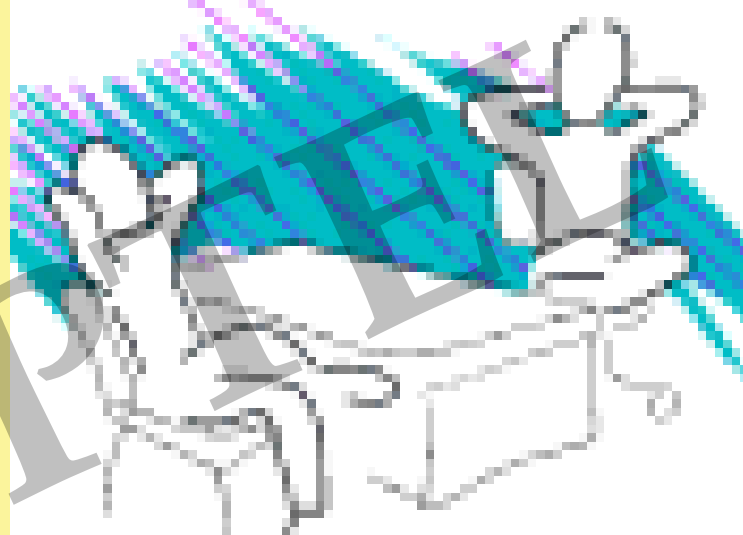
Fugitive (2 of 3)

- LET ME GO feet towards door
- Looking around
- Buttoning jacket



Fugitive (3 of 3)

- REJECTION sitting / moving back
- Arms folded
- Legs crossed 11 pos.
- (thigh on knee)
- Head down
- Frown



Combative (1 of 3)

- LET ME SPEAK finger tapping
- Foot tapping
- Staring



Combative (2 of 3)

- **AGGRESSIVE** leaning forwards
- Finger pointing
- Fists clenched



Combative (3 of 3)

- DEFIANT (standing)
- Hands on hips
- Frown



KINESICS: (d) Gesture

Gestures : the movements of our arms, legs, hands and feet



Arms

A. Arms crossed



Angry, disapproving



B. Open

Honest, accepting

How to improve your Body Language?

- Eye Communication
- Facial Expression
- Posture and Movement
- Gesture
- Dress and Appearance
- Voice and Delivery
- Non - words

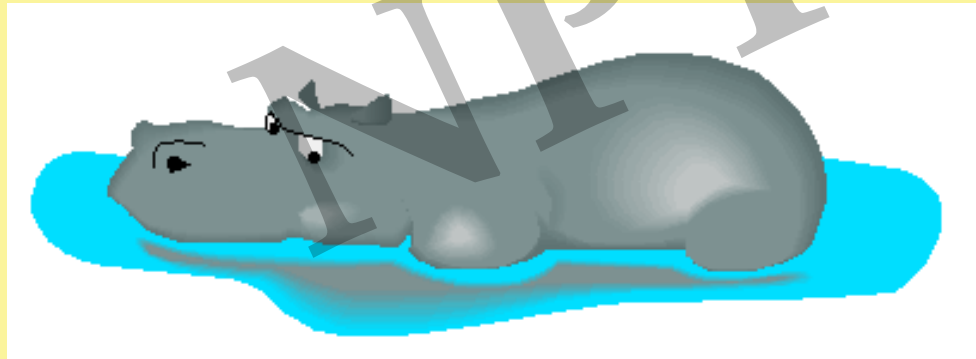
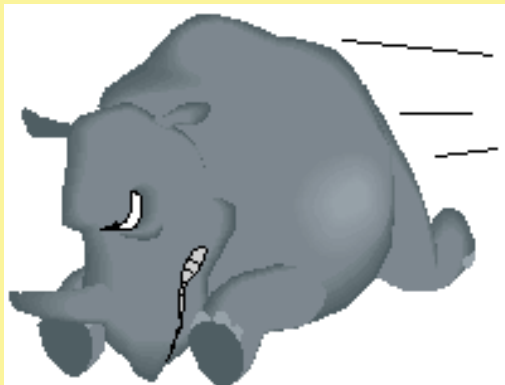
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1. Eye Communication

- Do you look at others when speaking or listening to others?
- Where do you look when you are speaking or listening to others?
- How long do you make eye contact when you look at others?

2. Facial Expressions – The Smile!

- What is the impression you wish to convey?
- Do you smile at others?
- Always smiling, never smile, sometimes



3. Posture and Movement

- Upper body
- Stand tall
- Watch your lower body
- Do you lean on left or right leg?
- Use the Ready Position
- Move
- Your own style

4. Gestures

- Find out your habits
- Do you gesture a lot or not at all?
- Where do your hands go when you are nervous?
- Find your nervous gestures
- How much gesture is appropriate?
- You can't over-exaggerate

5. Dress and Appearance

- Be appropriate
- Dress at the conscious level
- It's bigger than you think

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Impression Management: It's how you Dress and Appear!

- Hair combed and in an appropriate style
- Face clean (Girls should wear minimal make-up)
- Scent free, that is no perfume or after shave lotion
- Deodorant
- Teeth brushed and flossed
- Neck - free of jewelry
- Neck - if you have an open shirt, only top button is open
- Neck tie - appropriate for business setting
- Collar - is it buttoned?

Dress and Appearance: Conscious & Unconscious

- Hands clean with limited jewelry
- Clean and well manicured fingernails
- Watch - usually worn on left hand. Correct time?
- Belt - should be same color as shoes
- Belt - did you put it through all the loops ?
- Belt length - should be 5 inches longer than your waist
- Pants - ironed?
- Pants - buttoned
- Shoes - shining
- Shoes - same color as belt
- Most important!!! Your smile!

6. Voice and Delivery

- Do you know what kind of voice you have?
- Do you merely speak or does your voice resonate?
- Do you speak in a monotone or vary your delivery?
- How do you sound when you speak on the phone?

Voice and Vocal Variety

- Your voice transmits energy
- The sound of words
- Use vocal variety
- Don't read

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7. Non-words

- Which is your favorite non-word?
- Do you use technical words or jargon?
- Do you use slang?
- Do you use pause?
- How long do you pause?
- Do you pause for effect?

The Natural Self !

- Acknowledge your strengths and weaknesses
- Convert your weaknesses into strengths
- Learn like a juggler
- Communicating well is a lifelong affair

References

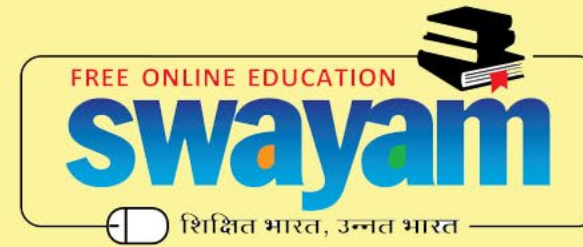
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3. Seiler and Beall's Communication: Making Connections, Pearson, 2005.
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Topic

Lecture 12: Body Language - Conclusion

CONCEPTS COVERED

1. Definition
2. Positive Gestures
3. Handshakes
4. Gazes
5. Smiles
6. Hand Movements
7. Styles of Walking
8. Voice Modulations



Body Language

Also known as Kinesics:

1. Facial Expressions

- Eyebrows Forehead
- Eyes
- Mouth

2. Posture

3. Gestures

4. Attractiveness

Body Language

The non-verbal manifestation of what we wish to convey to the receiver is evidenced in the manner we talk, walk, and position our hands. This can be defined as Body Language (or body sport) - played unconsciously by the body.



Positive Gestures

<i>TYPES</i>	<i>SIGNIFICANCE</i>
Open palms	Positive personality
Eye-to-eye contact	Honest and direct
Smile	Open personality
Equal handshake	Equal in behavior & attitude with no complexes associated



Handshakes

<i>TYPE</i>	<i>SIGNIFICANCE</i>
Equal handshake	Equal in behavior & attitude
Tight grasp	Superiority complex
Limp handshake	Inferiority complex & dejection
Politician's handshake	Deceptively subservient position
Informal handshake	Informal behavior & attitude









Gazes / Eye Movements

<i>TYPES</i>	<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Business	Eyes & forehead	Business transactions
Social	Forehead to lips	Social interactions
Intimate	From head to toe	Call for intimacy
Shifty eye	Eyes keep shifting	Lack of concentration
Evasive eye	Evasion of eye contact	Lack of credibility
Stammering eye	Trying to get into focus	Lack of confidence
Stuttering eye	Blinking & trying to get into focus in the initial phases	Shifty nature



Smiles (1 of 2)

<i>TYPES</i>	<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Felt smile	a. Upturned mouth with lips closed b. Upper set of teeth exposed with simultaneous eye contact c. Broad smile which exposes both sets of teeth	Appreciative of the interaction and happy

Smiles (2 of 2)

<i>TYPES</i>	<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Miserable smile	Only half the mouth is smiling	Disillusioned & dissatisfied
False smile	Slight turn at the end of the mouth. Does not reach the eyes.	Sarcastic / sardonic / dangerous





Hand Movements (1 of 4)

<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Hugging of the self	Uncertainty, lack of confidence
Arms folded with thumb pointing upward	Closed mind, superiority complex
Holding hands in front a. Left atop the right b. Right atop the left	- Artistic bend of mind - Logical bend of mind
Clasping of hands behind the neck	Aristocratic gesture, mark of royalty









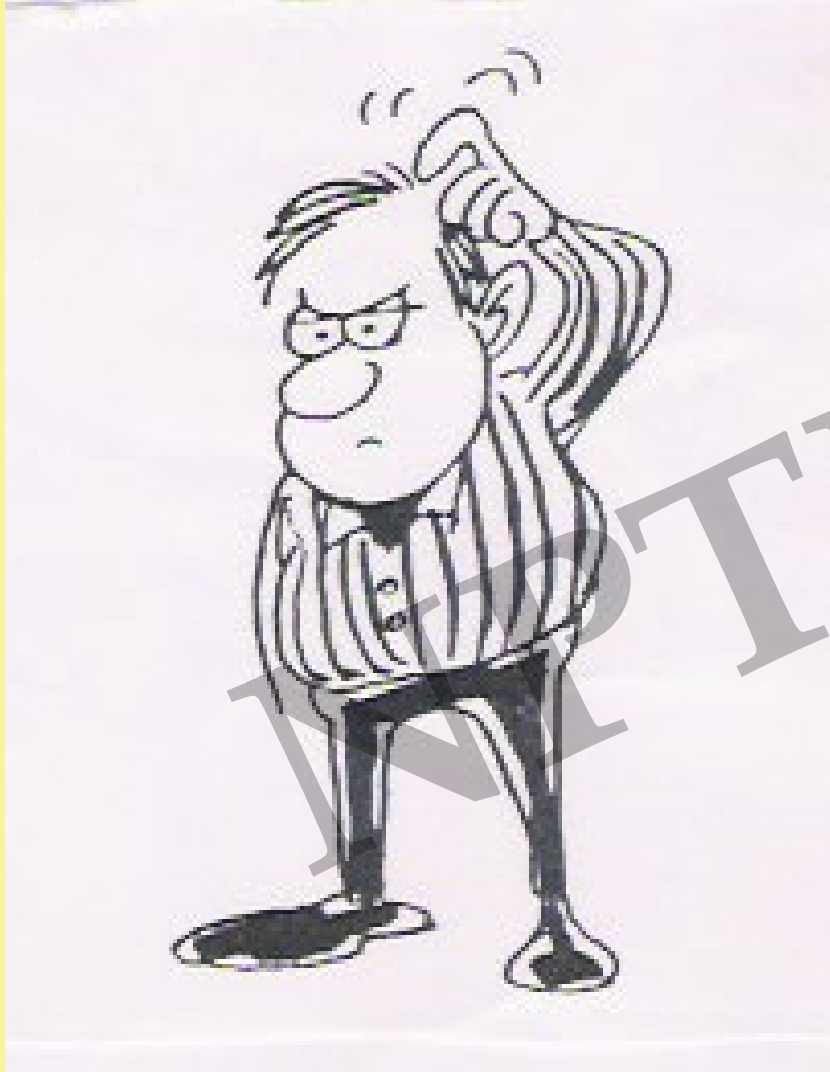
Hand Movements (2 of 4)

<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Hands resting lightly on the neck	Analyse the problem
Hands clasping the back of the neck	Danger signal
Scratching of head	Perplexity
Stroking of the chin	Ideas being given careful consideration
Lightly scratching or rubbing one side of the neck	Insecurity







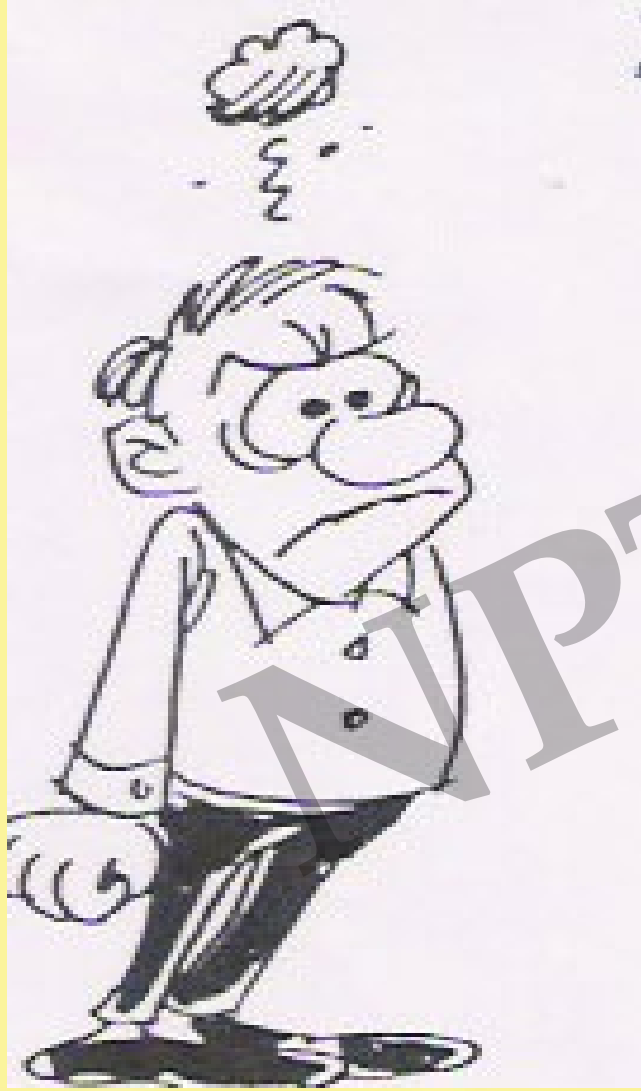




Hand Movements (3 of 4)

<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Clenching of hands a. Speaker b. Listener	a. Does not believe in what one is saying b. Frustrated and irritated
Both hands or one hand on hip	Signals authority
Hands down / fists clenched	Gearing for a showdown
Arms folded with thumbs pointing upwards	Closed temperament





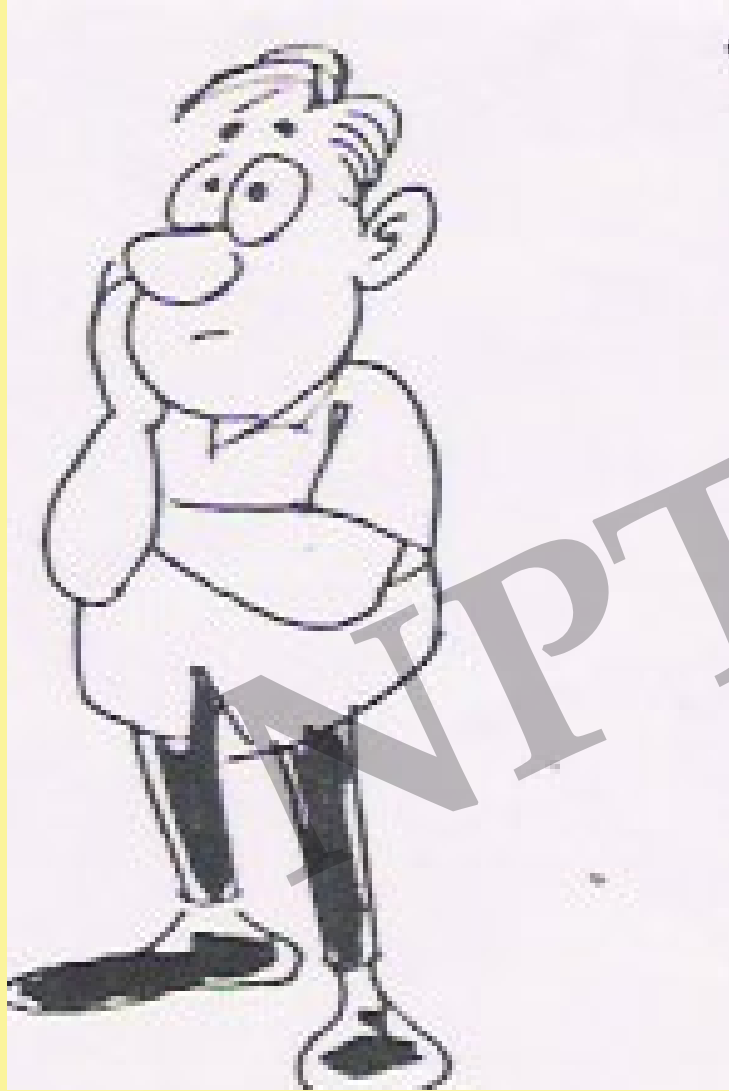


Hand Movements (4 of 4)

<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Rubbing of hands a. Quick rubbing b. Slow rubbing c. As if hands were being washed	a. Excitement / enthusiasm b. Preoccupation / deception c. Over with the issue
Pressing of hands in front of oneself	Pleading
Stapling of fingertips with thumb and first two finger	Extreme confidence bordering on eccentricity

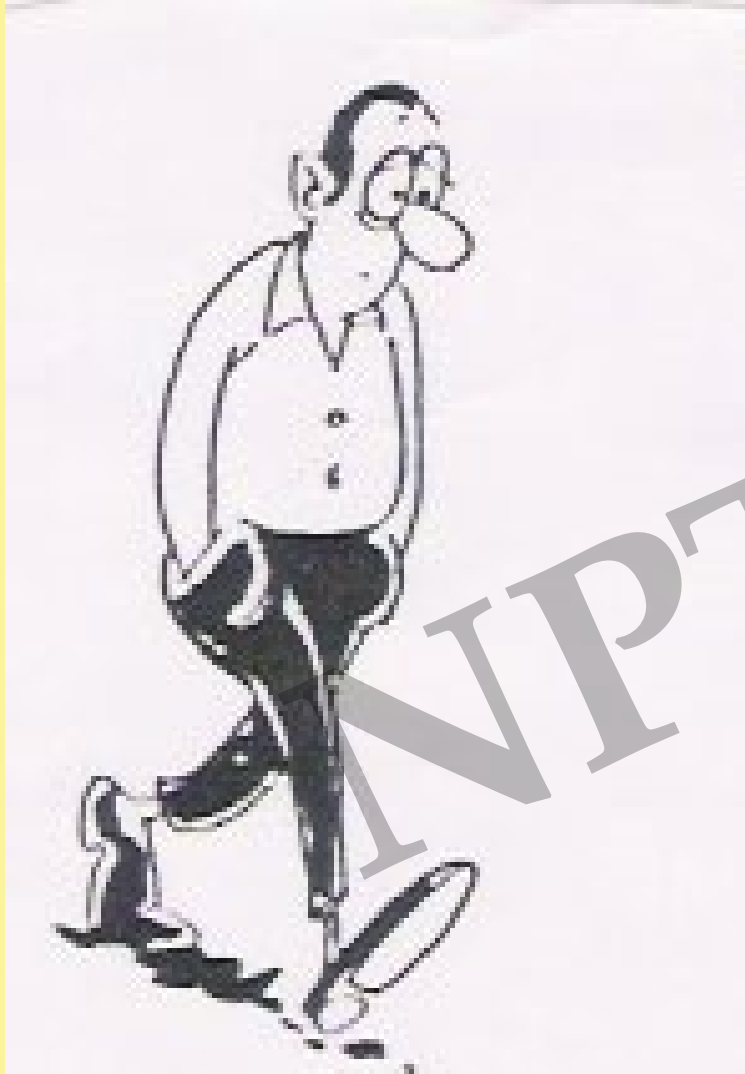


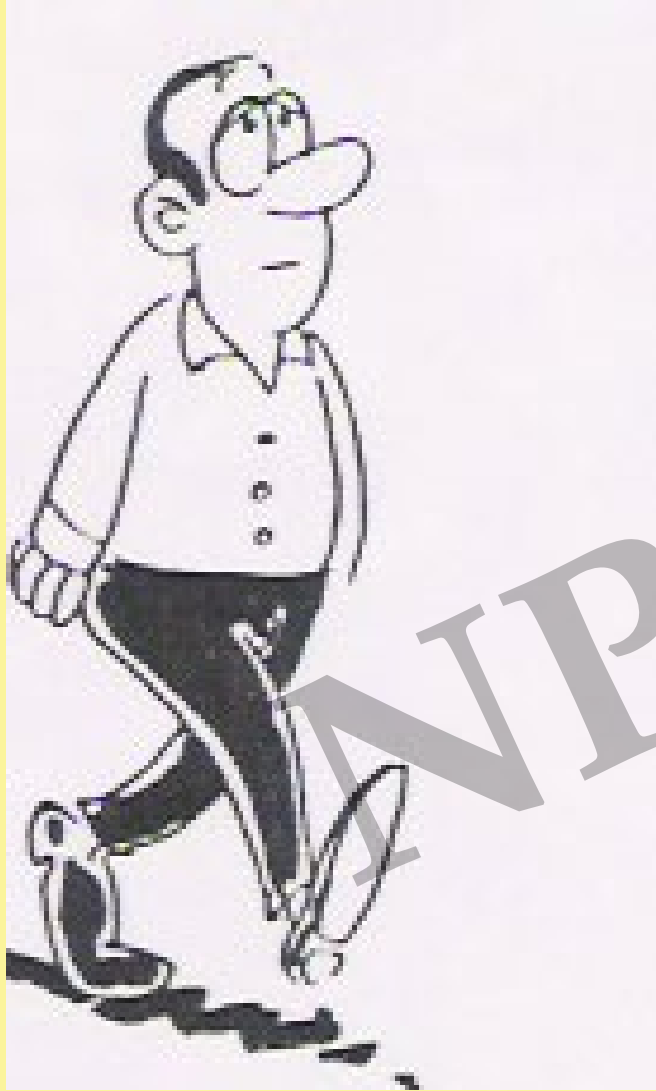




Styles of Walking

<i>TYPES</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Hands in pocket a. Walk disorganized, head bent b. Walk disorganized, kicking an imaginary object	Portrayal of macho image / withdrawn / shy / Critical - Depressed - Angry
Focusing of eyes a. On the ground b. In the air	- Lost in thought - Preoccupied/looking for answers on solutions
Strutting style of walking	Extreme certainty of opinion / confidence





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CHAPTER

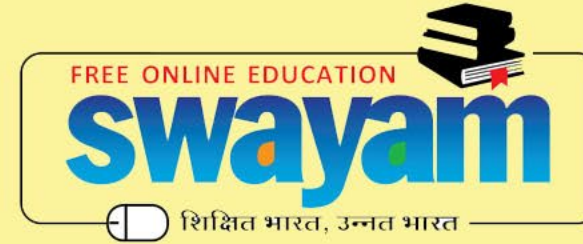
Voice Modulations

<i>MANNER OF PORTRAYAL</i>	<i>CONNOTATION</i>
Monotonous voice	Bored
Slow speed, low pitch	Depression
High pitch	Enthusiasm
High pitch, long drawn speech	Disbelief
Ascending tone	Astonishment
Abrupt speech	Defensive

References

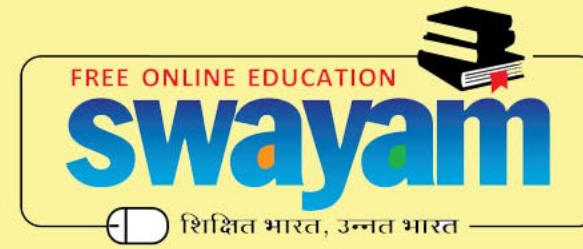
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Lecture 13: Listening Skills - Introduction

Listening and critical thinking

CONCEPTS COVERED

- Listening and Communication
- Feedback: A prerequisite for effective listening
- The role of critical thinking: Assessing the credibility of what you listen to
- Technology's influence on listening and thinking
- Increasing your ear power: A program for effective listening
- Summary



Chinese character for listening



Listening and communication

- Listening affects all kinds of communication
- The ethics of Listening
 1. How responsive a listener are you?
 2. Are you prepared to listen?
 3. How well do you use your listening time?
 4. How much of a role do you play in ensuring the integrity of a message?
 5. Are you ready to collaborate with the speaker?

Listening and communication

- **Listening versus Hearing**
 1. **Hearing**—involuntary, physiological process by which we process sound
 2. **Listening**—deliberate psychological process by which we receive, understand, and retain aural stimuli

Listening and communication

- Types of Listening
 1. Appreciative—for pleasure or relaxation
 2. Comprehensive—to gain knowledge
 3. Critical—to determine accuracy
 4. Emphatic—to understand feelings

Listening and communication

- Stages of Listening: More than meets the ear (Hurier Model)

1. Hearing
2. Understanding
3. Remembering
4. Interpreting
5. Evaluating
6. Responding

Listening and communication

Listening versus un-listening: Exploring the unethical behaviors of ineffective listeners

1. **Fraudulent listeners**
2. **Monopolistic**
3. **Competers**
4. **Selective listeners**
5. **Avoiders**
6. **Defensive listeners**
7. **Attackers**

Feedback: A prerequisite for effective listening

- What is feedback?

Feedback—information returned to a message source or a communicator

Feedback: A prerequisite for effective listening

- Types of feedback
 1. Evaluative feedback—positive or negative judgment OR Formative Feedback
 2. Non-evaluative feedback

Feedback: A prerequisite for effective listening

- **Evaluative feedback**
 - **Positive evaluative feedback**—tends to keep communication and its resulting behaviors moving in the direction they are already heading
 - **Negative evaluative feedback**—serves a corrective function in that it helps extinguish undesirable communicative behaviors
 - **Formative feedback**—timed negative feedback

Feedback: A prerequisite for effective listening

- Non-evaluative feedback—
 - Probing—non-evaluative technique in which we ask for additional information
 - Understanding—non-evaluative response that uses paraphrasing to check comprehension
 - Supportive feedback—non-evaluative response indicating that the receiver perceives a problem as important

Feedback: A prerequisite for effective listening

- Non-evaluative feedback—nondirective feedback
 1. “I” Messages—non-evaluative response that conveys our feelings about the nature of a situation
 2. “You” messages—response that places blame on another person
- Effects of feedback

The role of critical thinking: Assessing the credibility of what you listen to

- Critical thinking—careful and deliberate process of message evaluation
- What critical thinkers think about
- The critical versus the uncritical thinker
- Questions to facilitate critical thinking

Technology's influence on listening and thinking

- Advances in technology continue to add wrinkles
 - We can now be more selective about our willingness to listen



Gender and listening

- Women (when listening) rely more on their feelings and intuition
- Men tend to listen more comprehensively than women

Cultures influence on listening

- Western cultures are less open and tentative in their listening behavior
- Eastern cultures practice more speculative, metaphor thinking

Media and technology's influence on listening and thinking

- Research suggests that children are at risk for developing attention deficit problems compared to children who watch less TV

Increasing your ear power: A program for effective listening

- Focusing your attention
 - Red-flag words—words which trigger an emotional reaction and drop listening efficiency to zero
 - Speech-thought differential—difference between thinking and speaking rate
- Setting appropriate goals
- Listening to understand ideas

Increasing your ear power: A program for effective listening

- Listening to retain information
 - Repetition
 - Paraphrase—restate in your own words what another person has said
 - Visualization—the picturing of experience
- Listening to analyze and evaluate content
- Listening emphatically, listening actively

Increasing your ear power: A program for effective listening

- Listening to culture's influence
 - Dialogic listening—awareness of what happens between people as they respond to each other

Summary

- Listening is a deliberate process through which we seek to understand and retain aural stimuli.
- The average person listens at only 45 percent efficiency.
- Understanding and using the listening level-energy involvement scale can help us develop more effective listening skills.
- A prerequisite of effective listening is effective feedback.

Summary

- Feedback consist of all the verbal and nonverbal messages that a person consciously or unconsciously sends out in response to another person's communication.
- Improve your listening skills by learning to focus your attention while listening and by setting appropriate listening goals.
- Recognizing how culture, gender, and technology influence listening skills may further enhance our ability to develop more effective listening practices.

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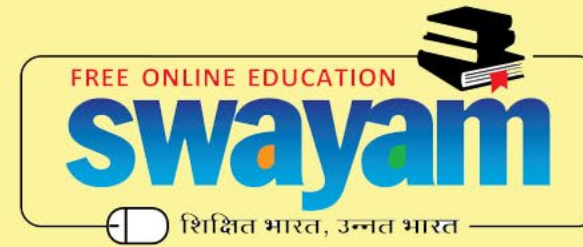
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Lecture 14: Listening Skills - Conclusion

CONCEPTS COVERED

1. Introduction
2. Active Listening
3. Components of Active Listening
4. Other Features of Active Listening
5. When NOT to Listen

MOVIE BREAK



CONCEPTS COVERED

PART II

- Decoding
- Essentials for good listening
- Deterrents to the Listening Process
- Feedback
- Helping yourself to listen
- Active ways of listening
- Summary Questions
- Developing your skills as a listener
- Importance of Listening
- Why do we Listen?
- Factors important in developing good Listening Skills



Listening Skills: Introduction

School teaches us to read, write, and speak, but rarely focuses on the skill of listening

This omission is unfortunate as listening skills are the most important foundation for any relationship, including working on a team

Listening often misunderstood as a passive activity

Better to view listening an *active* experience that requires attentive engagement with the speaker



Active Listening

Four key components to active listening

1. Attending responses
2. Open-ended responses
3. Tracking responses
4. Summarizing responses

1. Attending Responses - Verbal indicators

“Uh-huh,” “I see,” “Yes,” “Interesting,” “Hmm,” etc.

Friendly, informal, tentative tone of voice

Short statements and questions

Simple language (“talk” rather than “communicate,”
“write” rather than “correspond”)

Speaking less than 50% of the time



1. Attending Responses – Non Verbal indicators

Head nods & tilted head

Suitable facial expressions & natural smile

Open posture (rather than crossed arms)

Open palms (rather than clenched fists or fidgeting)

Regular eye contact (but don't stare)

Gestures that suit the context

Appropriate distance (usually arm's length)



2. Open-Ended Responses

Open-ended questions are ones that require more than a “Yes” or “No” answer
Usually start with or imply “What” or “How”

How do you see things changing?
What do you think is the problem?
What do you see as the most important issue?
What have you thought of?
I’m wondering . . . ?
What would you like to do about . . . ?
Could you tell me what that means?

2. Open-Ended Responses: Be cautious with ques.

Avoid leading questions that suggest you know the answer to the question (e.g., *You don't really want to do that do you?*)

Avoid *why* questions that imply judgments about the speaker's actions or motives (e.g., *Why didn't you try to solve the problem that way?*)

Avoid too many questions as that may suggest to the speaker that they are being interrogated

3. Tracking Responses

Reflecting checks your understanding of the content, words, or feelings expressed by the speaker:

Content: *“You mean Jahan hasn’t completed his part of the design specs?”*

Words: *“You say Jahan is not doing his share of the work?”*

Feelings: *“You feel angry at Jahan?”*



3. Tracking Responses (contd.)

Clarifying gathers further information:

Do you mean you don't you want this assignment?

Correct me if I'm wrong, but . . . ?

Silence (a brief pause) encourages people to talk.

Increase the length of your pauses to encourage the other person to talk more

Avoid excessively long periods of silence as that may be interpreted as a lack of interest or attention



4. Summarizing Responses

Summarize the conversation and then ask a question such as “*Is that accurate?*”

Wait 5-10 seconds for an answer

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Other features of Effective Listening

Minimize distractions

Listen with respect

Avoid assumptions

Avoid superficial reactions

Situate facts in context

Remain focused

When NOT to Listen

1. Speaker is verbally abusive
2. Speaker monopolizes conversation
3. Speaker is out of touch with reality

In these sorts of circumstances:

1. Be assertive
2. Point out that the person is behaving inappropriately
3. State that you will not continue conversation unless you are treated with respect
4. In extreme circumstances, end the conversation until the person has calmed down

big bang active listening

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When NOT to Listen

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Listening: a three-tier process

1. Listening
2. Sharpening
3. Assimilation

Information or messages are poured in the mind of the receiver.

The mind automatically sifts through the messages and chooses the ones it would prefer to focus pertaining to the interest area of the receiver.

Lastly it assimilates only those issues it thinks are of direct relevance to it.

Essentials for good listening

The primary essential is the cultivation of a positive attitude coupled with the ability to concentrate:

1. Positive attitude
2. Ability to concentrate
3. Enter into the Question-Answer sessions
4. Maintain eye contact
5. Conducive posture

Essentials for good listening

(contd.)

Essentials	Resultant Features
Positive attitude	Acceptance
Concentration	Receptivity
Question-Answer sequence	Concentration
Direct eye contact	Direct contact
Conducive body posture	Attention

Deterrents to the Listening Process

1. Ego
2. Involvement with the self/preoccupation
3. Past,present and future
4. Fear
5. The familiarity trip
6. Stress

Feedback

This is the most important part of communication that completes the entire loop.

A good strategy of giving feedback is to follow a three-tier process:

- 1.Listen to what the sender is trying to communicate**
- 2.Repeat the crux of the message to ensure that your intentions have been rightly understood.**
- 3.Give response to the message.**

Moving on the assumption that a stereotyped meaning can be applied to all situations can lead to miscommunication.

Feedback

Feedback can be of two types:

1. Confirmatory (chances are high that there has been miscommunication at some stage or the work input is much below expectations for which feedback is given.

2. Corrective feedback

Helping yourself to listen

There are three main ways of attending: physically, psychologically and verbally

- 1. Attending physically:** Following factors are important for physical attending: Facing the speaker squarely, maintaining good eye contact, maintaining an open posture, remaining relatively relaxed.
- 2. Attending psychologically:** To attend psychologically one needs to develop an ability to concentrate on the speaker and to what is being said, how it is being said, what is not being said, what feelings and emotions are being expressed or not.

Helping yourself to listen

(contd.)

3. **Attending verbally:** You listen by: making eye contact, nodding or shaking your head, asking questions, summing up what the speaker has been speaking, budding on what has been said, avoiding other distractions like phone ringing, people interrupting.

4. **What might be the intentions behind what the speaker is saying:** gain personal acceptance, justify a course of action, sow seeds of doubt, impose a viewpoint, promote agreement, release frustration, explore self-doubt, enhance self-view, butter-up, conceal emotions, provide a waterproof shoulder, seek support, be deliberately provocative, gain commitment, clarify thoughts, instill fear, rationalise a situation, make light of events.



Active ways of listening

Listening questions will be ones that:

1. Show interest or encouragement, eg. 'And then what happened?'
2. Seek further information, eg. 'Can you give me an example?'
3. Explore feelings, eg. 'How did you feel about that?'
4. Demonstrate understanding/clarify what has already been said, eg. 'So it seems as though...'

Summary Questions

A few questions can be used to summarise your understanding: 'As I understand it...?', 'If I've got it right...?', 'So what you're saying is...?'

Giving encouragement: Non-verbal noises (positive encouragement) and supportive statements like : 'I see...', 'And then...?', 'That's interesting...'

Keyword repetition

Reflective statements: The most usual form of reflection is expressed as a statement and tends to begin with phrases like 'You feel that...?' and 'It seems to you that...?'. In brief you are displaying empathy and 'putting yourself in the speaker's shoes-a skill identified with effective listening.

Summary

Question Form	Purpose
Non-verbal noises, supportive statements, key word repetition	To show interest/encouragement
Extension	To seek further information
Reflective statements	To explore feelings in detail
Summary	To demonstrate understanding/clarify information already given

Developing your skills as a listener

In the words of one research study, the ideal listener:

Primarily keeps an open, curious mind. He listen for new ideas everywhere, integrating what he hears with what he already knows. He is also self-perceptive and listens to others with his total being. Thus he becomes personally involved with what he hears...He looks for ideas, organization and arguments but always listens to the essence of things. Knowing that no two people listen the same, he stays mentally alert...

Developing your skills as a listener (contd.)

In the words of one research study, the ideal listener:

*...He is introspective but has the capacity and desire to critically examine, understand and attempt to transform some of his values, attitudes and relationships within himself and with others. He focuses his mind on the listening and listens to the speaker's ideas, but he also listens with feelings and intuition.**

*From 'A definition of listening', Ohio State University, 1968, by Elizabeth Mae Pflaumer



Why is listening important?

- Listening is the key to success
- Listening opens up new horizons

Why do we Listen?

- To gain information
- To get feedback
- To participate in another's story
- To hear of their experiences and insights
- To be 'in control' (information is power)
- To broaden our horizons, i.e. to learn
- To create a relationship
- To respect and value others

Factors important in developing good Listening Skills

Good listening is about being sensitive to the other person's:

- Voice
- Choice of words
- Tone
- Speed
- Body, i.e., their body language

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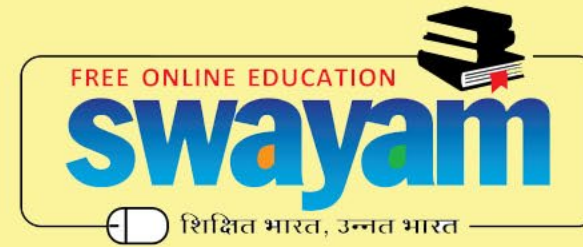
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**Thank
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Employment Communication **- A Lab based course**

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IIT Kharagpur

Lecture 15: Practice Session 1
Module II

Practice Session 1

Module II

CONCEPTS COVERED

1. Non Verbal Communication
2. Cross Cultural Communication



Non Verbal Communication

(Activity 1)

Role Play 1

Face to face with a man-eater...

Do not use any words. Use only gestures and, if necessary, nonlinguistic sounds.

Face to face with a man-eater... (Activity 1 - contd.)

You are an Indian sailor, the only survivor of a shipwreck near the west coast of Australia. You have been washed ashore. When you regain consciousness you find yourself faced with an Australian aborigine, most probably of the man-eating tribe of Western Australia.



Face to face with a man-eater... (Activity 1 - contd.)

The aborigine appears to be somewhat hostile. He might harm you. He might be dreaming of cooking and eating you with his friends. Reassure him that you are harmless and that you are not carrying any guns. Impress on him that you've had a shipwreck. Tell him that you are from a small village in India, that you have two elderly parents and four children to look after. If he doesn't turn violent, tell him that you are thirsty and hungry.

Could he give you some water and fruits? You are a vegetarian.

So let him know that you can't eat meat or fish.



Non Verbal Communication

(Activity 2)

Role Play 2

Face to face with a dangerous Foreigner...

Do not use any words. Use only gestures and, if necessary, nonlinguistic sounds.



Face to face with a dangerous Foreigner...

(Activity 2)

Role Play 2

You are an aborigine living on the western coast of Australia. This morning as you come out to fish in the shallow waters of the sea, you find a dangerous looking man lying on the beach. He is neither white nor black but somewhat brown. He is not from your part of the world. Now he is getting up and looking at you.

Face to face with a dangerous Foreigner...

(Activity 2 - contd.)

Hang on and find out what he is like. Use only gestures and, if necessary, non-linguistic sounds. He can't make sense of your words. More than anything else, be careful. Don't be too friendly. Ask him to get away before he gets into trouble. He may have one of those weapons that send out fire and smoke with a big sound. He might kill you if he stays on.

You can never trust these foreigners. Don't smile or show friendliness until you are sure his intentions are good and that he has no weapons.



Inter Cultural Communication

(Activity 3)

Role Play 3

Gone with the Wind....

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Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3– contd.)

Gone with the Wind: Background details

Muthangi Srinivas has been in the US for about five years now. Currently he is a Project Leader with the CAD software giant, Obelix Corp in California. His dashing looks, BTech from IIT Madras, MS from the US, and now job with Obelix Corp have made him hot property on the Andhra marriage market. Several rich, intelligent, and beautiful girls have been identified by his family for him to choose from and marry. But he has been telling them repeatedly during the last year or so that he didn't want to get married yet.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3– contd.)

Muthangi is a highly conservative and well respected Brahmin family at Ongole, Andhra Pradesh. Educating Srinivas and sending him to the US has set them back by about Rs one million. Father hopes to get not less than Rs five million by way of dowry so that he can pay back the massive debts and marry off his three daughters.

Srinivas has been sending home about \$ 500 every two months for a year now. (But of late he has been a bit irregular.) He is coming to India today on a month's holiday.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3– contd.)

Role play Participant A: You are Muthangi Srinivas.

You want to marry Carolyn, a Black American divorcee. A sales assistant at a department store in California, she came into your life a few months before you joined Obelix Corp. She pulled you out of deep depression and suicide. She gave you a second life. You love each other deeply. Six months ago you proposed to her. She accepted. You spend most evenings together, but don't live together. You know you are going to disappoint your family, especially Father. But you can't help it.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

Of course you could have told him about these developments when he was constantly pestering you on the phone with marriage proposals. But you couldn't muster enough courage to tell him. You thought you'd explain everything when you met him. But to reduce the shock, you telephoned Father just before you left the US and told him that you were bringing along your American fiancée. All you got was a stunned silence in reply.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

You've arrived at Ongole. Walk into your home and talk to your father. Now he will be alone. Your objective is to get him to accept your plan to marry Carolyn before your return to the US in four weeks. She also has come along with you to India. She is waiting in the hotel. She would like a traditional Indian wedding. She is willing to convert to Hinduism if necessary. The only thing she will not agree to is delaying the marriage beyond two or three months. She feels she has waited enough.

Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

You will not abandon Carolyn under any circumstances. You want to marry her with your parents' blessings and cooperation if possible. They've sacrificed so much for you. Talk to your father. Get him to agree to your marriage with Carolyn.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

You are Muthangi Satyanarayana, Srinivas's father.

What wonderful dreams you had woven around your son Srinivas! And he is coming home today after a gap of five long years. But he has let you down. He shocked you yesterday morning, just before he left the US, with the news that he was bringing along his American fiancée.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

First you didn't believe it. You were too stunned to say anything. But on reflection it made sense. Sreenu hasn't been regular either with phone calls or sending money during the last few months. Now he has no time for the family that sacrificed so much for him. The money might stop completely. Now how will you pay back the huge debts you've run up on account of his studies and trip abroad?



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

It is not just the money. How about the family's image in the community? Who will marry the girls now? In the long history of Muthangi family there has not been a single case of inter-caste marriage or even of love marriage. You don't want a dirty, beef-eating foreign daughter-in-law. She will violate the Muthangi tradition. You'd rather commit suicide than take her into the family. You will be a laughing stock in town. Many girls and their parents – all from your own community, but offering Rs three to seven million as dowry – are waiting. What would they think of you and the word you gave them? How could Srinivas do this to you and his loving sisters?

Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

Srinivas is arriving shortly. Talk to him when he comes. You don't want to lose him. Without his continued support you can neither repay the huge loan nor marry off the girls. Besides, he is your only son. Persuade him to see at least a couple of really pretty and intelligent girls (one a B.Tech. from IIT Kanpur) on your short list. Then he will change his mind. Use whatever strategy you think fit. It doesn't matter even if he gives up his job and returns to India for good.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 3–contd.)

The other members of the family have gone to the temple.
You haven't told them yet about the bomb that Srinivas had
dropped yesterday.



Inter Cultural Communication (Activity 4)

Objective: To display the different attitudes between a typical Westerner & a typical Indian with reference to observing Traffic rules



On the road...

(Activity 4 – contd.)

Mr ABC is driving a car in a big city. Time: about 2 am.

As he reaches a crossroads, his traffic light turns red. Absolutely no traffic in any direction. What is he likely to do

- If he was a typical American?

Why?

- If he was a typical Indian?

Why?

On the road...

(Activity 4 – contd.)

- a) Cross the road; there is no traffic in any direction. (No traffic police either.)
- b) Wait until his light turns green. A red traffic light is a red traffic light whether there is other traffic or not.
- c) Stop, check, and cross carefully. If he is absolutely sure that there is no traffic from any direction, it's OK to jump the red light.

Many Thanks and God bless

1st year Participants from the MHRM Programme

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